Using Activator in Microsoft Fabric

Understanding how Activator detects important events and triggers actions in real time

Activator is a tool in Microsoft Fabric that helps you watch live data, spot important conditions, and automatically take action when something needs attention. Think of it as a smart assistant that constantly monitors your data and reacts instantly when something goes wrong or needs follow-up [No one needs to sit and watch dashboards].

What Activator Does

Activator is an event detection and rules engine. It connects to real-time data sources, checks for specific conditions, and triggers actions like:

- Sending an email
- Posting a message in Microsoft Teams
- Running a Power Automate workflow
- Executing a Fabric notebook or pipeline

This makes it useful in situations where timing matters.

How Activator Works

1. Configure What to Monitor (Monitor Section)

   You choose the property Activator should watch and you can also summarize data to avoid reacting to tiny spikes. For example; Temperature monitoring, such as:

   Average, minimum / maximum, count, total.

   You control how much data to look at (*window size*) and how often to check (*step size*).

2. Define When to Act (Condition Section)

   You set the rule that tells Activator when something is wrong, such as:

   Temperature > 68°F, no new data for 30 minutes, value rising too quickly, etc.

   You can trigger actions immediately or only if the condition stays true for a while.

3. Focus the Scope (Property Filter)

   You can limit the rule to specific cases, such as:

   Only events where temperature is already high.

   This helps avoid unnecessary alerts.

4. Configure Actions (What Happens Next)

   When a rule is triggered, Activator can perform one of four actions:

   Email, Teams message, Power Automate, and Fabric item.

   Once actions are set, Activator is fully ready to respond automatically.

Why Activator Is Useful

Activator helps organizations:

- Catch problems early
- Respond instantly
- Automate repetitive tasks
- Improve safety and reliability
- Reduce manual monitoring

It’s especially valuable in industries like delivery, manufacturing, healthcare, finance, and IT operations.